ECONOMIC CULTURES · MODULE 1

MY HOURLY RATE

What does your hour need to earn?



a Situated Studio

a Situated Studio · Gemma Medina and Minsung Wang

THREE EVENINGS, SIX MODULES

EVENING	FIRST	AFTER THE BREAK
Tue 3 November	My hourly rate	From quote to invoice
Thu 5 November	Project budget	Seeds of Hope pt.1
Tue 10 November	Interdependence	Seeds of Hope pt.2

17.00 to 21.00, Room 2A. Each module takes about 90 minutes.

THE TOOLS AND MATERIALS, ALSO AFTERWARDS

bronvandoen.github.io/tags/economic-cultures

THANKS FOR BEING HERE

HOW WE WORK

This is a safe space to speak your mind; ask any question and make plenty of mistakes.

Respect each other’s time, effort and opinions.

Say hello to unfamiliar faces, we are here to learn from each other.

Please give us your full attention. We keep time quite strictly ☺

We take photos for documentation. Tell us if you’d rather not be in them.

WHY WE’RE HERE

WE ARE NOT BUSINESS COACHES

Art and design schools rarely talk about money. For many of you, this is the first time you put a price on an hour of your own work.

You can’t budget a project without it. So we start from your life.

BEFORE WE START

A SOFT EXERCISE

We start with something light. On the way, we form the cell groups you work in for this module.

YOUR RATE COMES FROM YOUR LIFE

It is not a price on your talent. Start from Sam’s or Noor’s numbers, then make them yours.

Nothing you type leaves your phone.

bronvandoen.github.io/tools/economic-cultures/ hourly-rate

MY LIFE RIGHT NOW

The year after your graduation show. What does a month of your life cost?

PAUSE

What did you forget? Change a number, or put it under “Everything else”.

BEING MY OWN EMPLOYER

An employer quietly pays for things you now carry yourself.
Which ones do you take on?

NOW YOU TAKE CARE OF YOURSELF, YOUR FUTURE INCLUDED.

business.gov.nl
Starting as a sole proprietor, in English

kvk.nl
The Chamber of Commerce, where you register

belastingdienst.nl
What changes for your taxes when you start

RUNNING MY PRACTICE

What does your practice cost in a year, whether or not any work comes in?

PAUSE

What did the school pay for? Workshops, machines, software, printing.

BOOKKEEPING, THREE ROUTES

Software, you keep the books: about €10 to €30 a month

Online service, software and a bookkeeper: about €60 to €70 a month

Accountant, a person who knows you: ask for a quote

THE STATE'S SHARE

Part of what you earn goes to the state. How much depends on what you earn and that year's rules.

INCOME TAX

Inkomstenbelasting, on the profit you make.

ZVW CONTRIBUTION

The income-related part of health care.

We're not tax consultants, but we can show you the principle.

PAID AND UNPAID HOURS

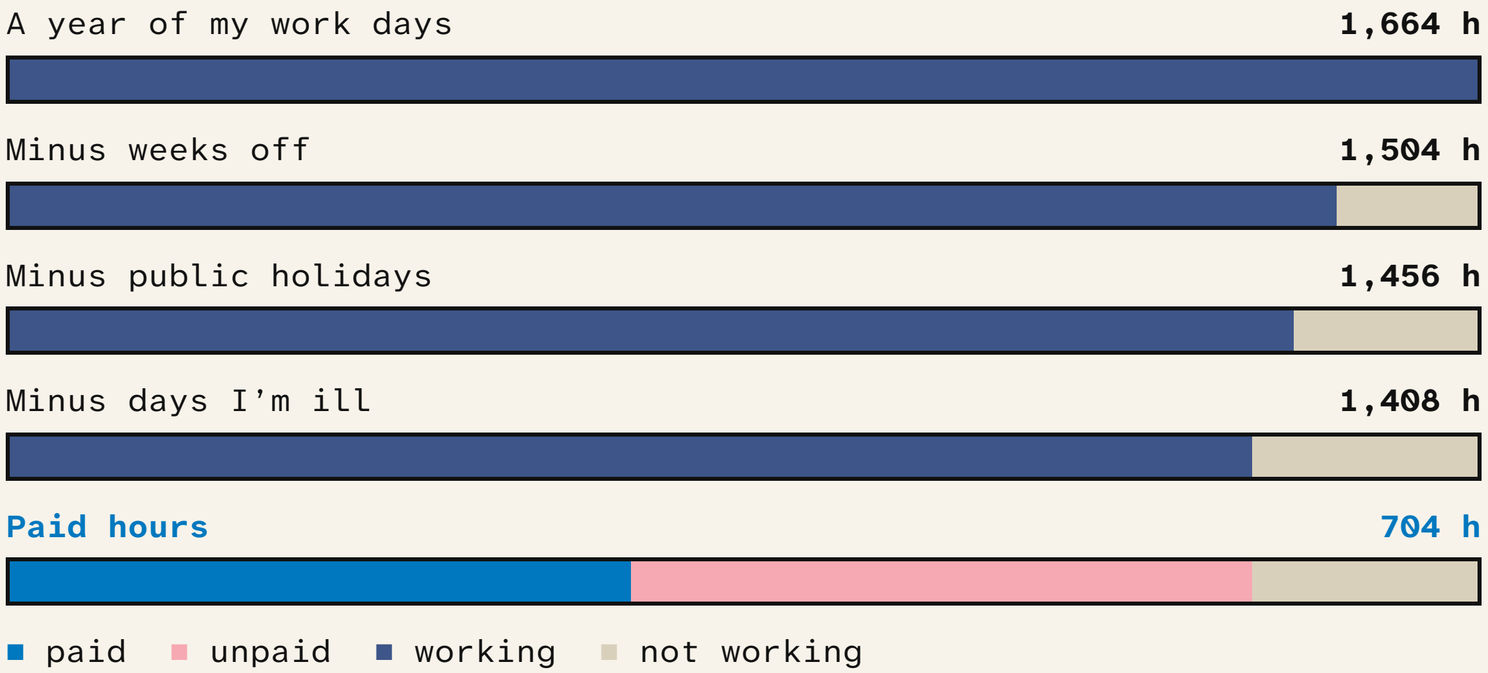
A year has fewer working hours than you think. And of the hours you work, only part is paid.

emails | admin | applications | your portfolio | research | your own projects | learning

TALK

Which hours of your week does nobody pay for?

MY YEAR IN HOURS



PAUSE

Look at the last line. How does it feel?

MY RATE

€100

Your rate. You keep this.

+ €21

21% VAT. It goes to the tax office.

= €121

What your client pays.

TALK

Share your rate in your group, without judging. What made yours higher, or lower?

Swiss designers, median CHF 120–135 (≈ €130–147) an hour · SDA 2025

VERSIONS OF ME

Your rate is not fixed. As your life changes, so do your standards. Try on a different life.

GIVE THE MONEY A NAME.

Gemma’s story: Giving the money a name

MY VERSIONS SIDE BY SIDE

	NOW	CHANGES IN LIFE
A month of my life	€1,400	€1,525
Employer part, a year	€1,944	€5,664
Practice, a year	€2,900	€2,900
Paid hours	704	672
Hourly rate	€37.40	€48.89
Day rate	€299	€391

SAM TICKED

A pet
+€125 a month

Saving for later
+€300 a month for a pension

More rest
+2 weeks off a year

1 Step 6: save your rate as "Now".

2 Step 7: tick life cards, save as a version.

3 Compare them here, and again in step 9.

WHAT COULD BE SHARED

Not all value is money. Some costs get lighter when you carry them with others.

Tick a cost and it is divided by the people you share it with. Add what you would only have together: a risograph, a van.

IMAGINE

Who in this room would you share a studio with?

TAKE IT WITH YOU

Save the PDF or the link before you close the page. We keep nothing. You will use your rate again in the next modules.

TO TAKE HOME

- What is your money for? Give three things a name.
- Which version feels most like the life you want? What is a first step towards it?
- Which of your unpaid hours would you like someone to pay for, and who?
- Who could you share something with?

What does your hour need to earn?

YOUR HOUR HAS A NUMBER NOW, AND IT COMES FROM YOUR LIFE.

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WE CONCLUDE THIS MODULE

GOOD WORK!

Let’s take a moment to reflect on what just happened.

Tell us what you felt and learned. A few lines are enough.

HOW WAS THIS MODULE?



bronvandoen.github.io/feedback

Tue 3 Nov · My hourly rate